

# Plaque Incision and Grafting

Patient Information · Surgery to straighten the penis (Peyronie's disease)

WARWIKI

In Peyronie's disease, a scar (plaque) inside the penis can make it bend during an erection. This can make sex hard. In this surgery, the scar on the short, tight side of the penis is cut to release the bend. Sometimes part of it is removed. The gap is then covered with a patch called a graft.

## About This Procedure

The scar pulls one side of the penis tight, so it bends. The surgeon cuts through the scar on the **short (inner) side**. This opens a gap, which is covered with a **graft**. The graft may be a collagen patch, processed animal or donor tissue, or tissue from your own body, such as the inside of your cheek. Because the short side is made longer, this surgery **aims to keep your length**.

### It is used when:

- Your curve is **severe or complex**, for example an hourglass shape or a hinge
- Keeping your **length** matters, and plication would shorten it too much
- Your **erections are strong**, with or without help from pills

## Benefits and Risks in Numbers

### 8–10 in 10

men get a straight erection

### 2–46 in 100

get new or worse erection problems; the risk varies a lot between studies

### 1 in 5

have less feeling in the penis at first; for most it returns within a year

Numbers are averages from published studies. Your own risk may differ; ask your team.

## What to Know

- **Length** is usually kept, but this is not guaranteed. About 3 in 4 men keep or gain measured length, yet many still feel the penis is shorter.
- **Erection problems** are more likely than with plication. That is why this surgery is offered only when erections are strong. If your erections are weak, a penile implant may be the better choice.
- **Less feeling** in the head of the penis usually comes back within 6 to 12 months. It rarely lasts.

## Learn the Terms

### Peyronie's disease

A scar in the penis that makes it bend during an erection.

### Plaque

The patch of scar tissue that causes the curve.

### Graft

A thin patch that covers the gap after the scar is cut.

### Plication

A simpler surgery that straightens with stitches but shortens the penis.

### Artificial erection

An erection made with an injection during surgery, so the surgeon can see the curve.

### Circumcision

Removal of the foreskin. It is often done at the same time.

**Will it hurt?** You will be asleep or numb during surgery, so you feel nothing. The operation takes longer than plication. Afterward, expect swelling, bruising and soreness of the penis for 1–2 weeks. Ice, snug underwear and pain medicine help.

## First days

Rest at home. You may have a catheter for a short time.

## Weeks 1–2

Swelling and bruising settle. Keep the area clean.

## Weeks 1–8

No sex while the graft heals.

## Weeks 6–8

Sex again once your team says you have healed.

## How to Get Ready

- Your Peyronie's should be **stable**: the curve has not changed for at least 3 months. Your **erections are checked** first.
- Follow your surgery instructions about eating, drinking and which medicines to stop, including blood thinners.
- Stop smoking. Any infection is treated first.

### Tell your team ahead of time if you:

- Have **weak erections**, or need pills or injections for erections
- Take a blood thinner, or have had penile surgery before

## What Happens During Surgery

- 1 You receive anesthesia and antibiotics.
- 2 An injection makes an **erection** to show the curve. The nerves on top of the penis are gently moved aside.
- 3 The scar is cut, the gap is covered with a **graft**, and the result is checked with another erection.

Once the swelling settles, your team may have you take an erection pill or use a stretching (traction) device while you heal.

### Call the office that did your surgery if you have:

- A temperature of **100.4 °F (38 °C)** or higher, or chills
- Redness, pain or fluid from the cut that is getting worse
- Bruising or swelling that keeps growing

### Go to an emergency department if:

- You cannot urinate
- Bleeding will not stop, or swelling grows fast
- You cannot reach the office and are worried

### Three Things to Remember

1. This surgery straightens the penis and aims to keep its length.
2. The main risk is new erection problems, so it is only for men with strong erections.
3. No sex for about 6–8 weeks, until your team says you have healed.